proliferation, they conveniently turned into active collaborators for countries where they had high stakes. During the various United Nations meetings on nuclear non-proliferation, India made it clear that it had no intention to engage in any arms race but would never sign a discriminatory agreement that would allow some powers to keep their nuclear programmes but impose sanctions on some countries for working on nuclear capability.

In September 1981, India tabled a working paper at the UN Committee on Disarmament, suggesting that a universally acceptable system of controls and non-discriminatory criteria should be made applicable to all countries without exception. The MEA said:

India believes that total nuclear disarmament has become a most urgent task in view of the perils facing mankind from an escalating nuclear arms race. Lasting peace cannot be built on the fear of nuclear weapons but must rest on the

foundations of a general and complete disarmament under effective international control. To be meaningful, nonproliferation of nuclear weapons must cover both horizontal and vertical proliferation. Any discriminatory approach to this question is not only unjust but also unworkable. The principal task of our foreign policy, as before, will be to promote our ideals and preserve our interests in a rapidly changing international environment.

At around the same time, R&AW officers were keeping an eye on the political and public mood in Europe on the disarmament issue. The agency's analysis prompted India to press for a resolution in the United Nations General Assembly in 1981 that